01 / CHOOSE YOUR EXAM

Which B2 First?

B2 First

Formerly called the First Certificate in English (FCE). It is aimed at adult learners and tests English for study, work and everyday life.

B2 First for Schools

The same B2 level and exam format, with topics suited to the interests and experiences of school-age learners.

BEFORE YOU BOOK

Both versions are available in digital and paper-based formats. Check which dates and formats your local exam centre offers.

EXAM VERSIONS

05 / RESULTS & NEXT STEPS

Your score

The overall score averages five Cambridge English Scale scores: Reading, Use of English, Writing, Listening and Speaking.

SCORE	RESULT	CEFR
180–190	Grade A	**C1**
173–179	Grade B	**B2**
160–172	Grade C	**B2**
140–159	Level B1	**B1**

Scores of 122–139 appear on the Statement of Results only. A certificate starts at 140 (B1) and a B2 result at 160.

OFFICIAL CAMBRIDGE RESOURCES

Exam format

Results and grading

Free sample papers and practice

cambridgeenglish.org

SCORES & PREPARATION

EXAM CANDIDATE'S GUIDE

B2 First

Cambridge English

FCE & First for Schools

Find out what happens in each paper and what your Cambridge English Scale score means.

R **Reading & Use of English**

W **Writing**

L **Listening**

S **Speaking**

Four papers · About 3½ hours

CAMBRIDGE ENGLISH QUALIFICATIONS

02 / PAPER 1

Reading & Use of English

75 MIN / 7 PARTS / 52 QUESTIONS

Work with different texts and show how well you understand and use grammar and vocabulary.

1. **Multiple-choice cloze** Choose a word for each gap.
2. **Open cloze** Supply the missing word in each gap.
3. **Word formation** Change a given word to fit the gap.
4. **Key word transformations** Rewrite a sentence with the same meaning using the given word.
5. **Multiple choice** Answer questions about a text.
6. **Gapped text** Put missing sentences back into a text.
7. **Multiple matching** Find which text or section contains the information.

READING, GRAMMAR & VOCABULARY

03 / PAPER 2

Writing

80 MIN / 2 TEXTS

Write 140–190 words for each part. Both pieces of writing carry equal weight.

PART 1 / COMPULSORY ESSAY

Give your opinion on the question. Discuss the two ideas provided and add one idea of your own.

Example Should towns make it easier for people to cycle?

PART 2 / CHOOSE ONE TASK

Write an article, email or letter, review, or another text from the options given. A report is specific to B2 First, while a story is specific to B2 First for Schools.

Example Review a café and say who would enjoy going there.

ESSAY & CHOICE OF TASK

04 / PAPERS 3 & 4

Listen & speak

Listening

≈40 MIN / 4 PARTS / 30 QUESTIONS

You hear each recording twice. The tasks include multiple choice, sentence completion and matching speakers to statements.

Speaking

14 MIN PER PAIR / 4 PARTS

Usually taken with another candidate and two examiners.

1. **Interview** Answer questions about yourself.
2. **Photo comparison** Compare two photos for one minute. Give a short response after your partner’s turn.
3. **Joint task** Discuss options with your partner and try to reach a decision.
4. **Discussion** Answer broader questions linked to the joint task.

LISTENING & SPEAKING